

of job is important. Don't get stuck with a job you don't like.

## STEP 2 Set Up Your Workstation

Once you have narrowed down your choice of employment, you can set up your workstation. You need to make sure that your future work area is very comfortable—use ergonomic furniture, wherever possible.

**For Writers/Editors:** A fast PC is a pre-requisite, you may also have to install software such as MS Office/Open Office, QuarkXPress or Adobe InDesign.

**For Designers:** Although it's not important to invest in a Mac (Apple Macintosh), make sure your PC has enough RAM (at least 1GB), hard disk space, and install a good graphics card. You also need to install a design software such as Adobe Photoshop, 3D Studio Max, Quark, Corel Painter, or Adobe InDesign.

**For Data Entry/Typing Assignments:** A computer, MS Office/Open Office, or other data-entry software.

**For Medical Transcription:**



Use the Resume Builder feature on job-sites to prepare a top-notch resume

Medical transcription involves transcribing medical records dictated by doctors (patient history, records, notes, lab reports), usually located in clinics abroad. Basic requirements include a PC with about 20 GB hard disk space, 256 MB RAM (minimum), sound card and Internet access. You would also require headphones, word processing software, and a good dictionary.

## STEP 3 Prepare Your Portfolio

Prepare a good resume, entering the right key words under 'Objective'. Use sites like Monster ([www.monster.com](http://www.monster.com)), JobsAhead ([www.jobsahead.com](http://www.jobsahead.com)), Naukri ([www.naukri.com](http://www.naukri.com)), IT-

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people ([www.it-people.com](http://www.it-people.com)), and Times Jobs ([www.timesjobs.com](http://www.timesjobs.com)) to get a basic understanding of the job profile. Use Resume Builder on these sites (needs registration) and on MS Word.

## STEP 4 Set Up A Web Site Or Blog

Create a good web site (one that's not too garish, text or image heavy). Use services such as Godaddy.com or Net4India.com or free services such as, Geocities to purchase domain space. If you are a freelance photographer or graphic designer, put up thumbnails of your work on the site. You could also set up a web log (blog) on sites such as Blogger.com and LiveJournal.com. Don't forget to provide your e-mail address, resume, and contact details at a prominent location on the site.

## STEP 5 Browse the Web

Use the best search engines in the business (Google, Yahoo!, MSN Search, and the right keywords ('freelance programming', 'freelance translation') to find the jobs you want. Don't provide personal details while registering on a website unless its absolutely essential. Rent-a-coder ([www.rentacoder.com](http://www.rentacoder.com)), a freelance-sourcing site has a ranking system to rate the work of freelancer programmers, and help companies choose people best suited for a particular project. Guru.com ([www.guru.com](http://www.guru.com)) and I Hire Programmers ([www.ihireprogrammers.com](http://www.ihireprogrammers.com)) are other popular freelance sites.

## STEP 6 Network

It's very, very important to 'connect' with the outside world. Join networking groups such as Friendster ([www.friendster.com](http://www.friendster.com)) and Ryze ([www.ryze.com](http://www.ryze.com)), have your blog linked to blog rings, and enroll in forums, user groups and other specific online communities. A caveat—online communities have their own set of protocols and etiquette. Remember to follow the rules; don't forward your resume to everyone you meet.

## STEP 7 Create A Work Schedule And Meet Deadlines

Create a 'work culture' for yourself. Just because there is no 'boss' breathing down your neck, you can't afford to slacken or miss

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